

Literature

Poetry Study
General Lit.
History of Lit
Plays
Poetry Reading





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): General Lit.: Grades 9-10, History of Lit: Grades 9-12, Plays: Grades 9-12, Poetry Study: Grade 9, Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

About Poetry Study: Grade 9

Continuing in their poetry studies, students review a wide variety of poetic forms, learn how they have evolved over the centuries, and practice writing their own poems.

About General Lit.: Grades 9-10

Journey into the 19th century with novels, short stories, personal narratives, fairy tales, and more. Students engage with a variety of authors and texts from the time period and reflect on literary techniques and the characteristics of multiple genres along the way.

About History of Lit: Grades 9-12

Using Marshall's and Long's spines along with a variety of primary sources and additional readings, the History of Literature course introduces students to literary movements and figures in the 19th century. The course prioritizes influential texts in the English-speaking world but also seeks to give students glimpses at literary developments across the globe.

About Plays: Grades 9-12

Students read Shakespeare's plays with additional optional readings and extra helpings from the time period.

About Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

In addition to reading a variety of poems from 19th century authors, students read biographies of two famous 19th century poets and dive into Virgil's Aeneid.

Plays: Grades 9-12

William Shakespeare (1564-1616) is perhaps the greatest writer in the English language. Reading and speaking his beautiful words will delight students as they learn his timeless stories, meet a variety of characters, enrich their minds, and instruct their consciences. Students will begin by simply enjoying the plays and later by writing short compositions, comparisons, and commonplace entries. Shakespeare covers the wide panorama of human experience through his nearly 40 plays; the comedies, tragedies, and histories that students read will spark their imaginations with stories that transcend time and culture.



Placement & Combining Tips

Poetry Study: Grade 9

Prerequisite: Grade 8 Poetry Study or a working knowledge of poetic forms and terminology.

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

Suitable for hungry 8th graders. Can be combined easily with Grades 11-12.

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

Lessons are shared across high school grades with grade-specific assignments in the lesson plans as appropriate.

Plays: Grades 9-12

This year, this course is the same as Shakespeare for Grades 5-8 with the only difference coming in Extra Helpings and additional options for further study.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Students new or struggling in their relationship with poetry should use Grade 8 lessons.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9	Poetry Study: Grade 9 2 times/week 15 min	The Making of a Poem
9-10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 2 times/week 30 min	Frankenstein Silas Marner Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass The Souls of Black Folk Up from Slavery Short stories and other writings
9-12	History of Lit: Grades 9-12 1 time/week 30 min	American Literature English Literature for Boys and Girls History of Literature PDF
9-12	Plays: Grades 9-12 1 time/week 30 min	The Tempest The Tempest (Audio recording) Henry IV Part 2 Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording) The Winter's Tale The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)
9-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 2 times/week 15 min	Poetry The Aeneid The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar The Crescent Moon

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

☐ For Term 1, read the translator's Preface (p.I-XXIII) to Celebrated Cases of Judge Dee and the Introduction (p.3-21) to Scarlet Letter to have enough context for the story to engage in discussion with your student(s) even if you are not able to read the full books. Reading Like a Serpent (linked in Extra Helpings) is also an excellent resource for students and teachers wishing to dive deeper into The Scarlet Letter.

☐ A Tale of Two Cities (Term 3) is a long novel, and to allow students to digest, write narrations, and enjoy the story, only about half of it is scheduled over the term. If you wish students to finish it, consider starting the book in Term 2 after the Gulliver's Travels lessons OR allowing students to read the book on their own time if interested (during or after the end of the term).

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

☐ Print off the History of Literature PDF, as students will need to annotate and mark up various sections throughout the year.

☐ Although sources were condensed into one PDF when possible, there are still quite a few outside links due to the number of primary sources referenced, so make sure your student(s) has/have access to the internet for their course.

Plays: Grades 9-12

- ☐ You may want to read "Shakespeare and a Christian Worldview," which is Ch.9 in the book Echoes of Eden – Reflections on Christianity, Literature, and the Arts by Jerram Barrs. This is an excellent overview of why Shakespeare is important for everyone to know, including Christians.
- ☐ If your students are new to Shakespeare, read the tips for beginners (Found in Appendix link)
- ☐ You may want to read a retelling beforehand so you are familiar with the play. (Suggestions found in Extra Helpings)
- ☐ Read the discussion questions and skim the summaries of each scene each week before the reading to help guide emphasis and discussion with your students.
- ☐ Consider purchasing puppets to use while reading to keep track of all the characters.

NOTE on VERSIONS

Students should have an unabridged copy that is not in a modern language edition, such as the ones linked in the program. The language complexity gets easier to understand with practice. (Note: Shakespeare's work does often contain bawdy jokes or off-color content that will go over the heads of students if left in its original form; a modern language version will lay it all right out there in plain, modern English.) We like the Folger editions because they are inexpensive, the lines are numbered (making it easy to find your place), and they contain good notes. These are available on the Folger website as free PDFs as well, though the notes are omitted.

NOTE on CONTENT

Teachers are sometimes wary of reading Shakespeare with their students because the plays do contain material that they would deem inappropriate. The Alveary generally follows Mason's programs for younger students. That does not mean, however, that your student will never encounter anything unsavory. Our best advice is to read in such a way that these things are moved over quickly, without added attention being drawn to them. Mason assures us that Shakespeare provides students with rich language and character lessons that are unparalleled.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Literature: Grade 9

Poetry Study: Grade 9



The Making of a Poem

General Lit.: Grades 9-10



Frankenstein



Silas Marner



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass



The Souls of Black Folk



Up from Slavery

Short stories and other writings

History of Lit: Grades 9-12



American Literature



English Literature for Boys and Girls



History of Literature PDF

Plays: Grades 9-12



The Tempest



The Tempest (Audio recording)



Henry IV Part 2



Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording)



The Winter's Tale



The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Poetry



The Aeneid



The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist



Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar



The Crescent Moon



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Literature: Grade 9

- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

- ∞ [History of Literature PDF](#)

Plays: Grades 9-12

- ∞ [Appendix: Ideas for Students New to Shakespeare](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Literature: Grade 9

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Introduction - Romanticism

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

What authors and books come to mind when you think about literature in 19th century? You may be familiar with terms such as the "Romantic period" or "Victorian period." Tell or jot down anything that comes to mind.

Over the year we'll learn about the lives and writings of people who wrote from about 1800-1900 AD. These individuals wrote in a wide array of genres: poetry, essays, short stories, plays, science fiction, mysteries, thrillers, children's stories, and more. When possible, the readings scheduled in History of Lit will align with what you are reading in your Poetry and General Literature courses.

We'll focus on authors who wrote in English but will also spend some time getting a taste for influential texts written in other languages as well. Every culture has significant texts and stories, so while we're limited in this course to English texts and texts translated into English, it's important to remember there is a world of books and literary traditions from cultures around the world which we don't have the time or often the language to read in this course!

English writings from the end of the 18th century into the first half of the 19th century are sometimes grouped together as part of the "Romantic Period." As with any generalization, this is a label scholars have put on the time frame as they look back, not something authors were so much thinking about consciously as they wrote, although as we will see, writers and poets from this period were often aware that their style of writing was something new.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: History of Lit PDF "The Romantic Period" p.#-# (7 pages)

- What are some of the themes to look out for when you read literature from the Romantic Period? How did Romantic writers break with the traditions of Classicism? Do you recognize any ideas about poets and poetry in this reading that are still current today? How would you say our time is different or similar? What "rules" define literature written in English today?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Transition from Classicism to Romanticism

→ INTRO

Towards the end of the eighteenth century, writers were beginning to break from the rules of Classicism and experiment with poetic subject matter and form that, in retrospect, seem more aligned with the themes of Romanticism. Today, you will read a few works by three poets who bridge these two time periods: Thomas Gray, William Cowper, and Robert Burns.

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard

- What is the setting of the poem, and how does Gray use this setting to create a mood or tone for the poem? What do you think the poet is saying about death and memory?

∞ Link: The Shrubbery

- How does the speaker show that there is a disconnect between how he feels and where he is? What is his relationship to the nature he sees around him?



Term 1

- ∞ Link: To a Mouse
- If the language seems hard, try reading it out loud!
- This poem ends with a turn - why does the speaker see the mouse as "blest, compar'd wi' me!"?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 1

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

William Wordsworth

→ INTRO

We will learn more about William Wordsworth (1770-1850) in the History of Literature lesson next week, but today's reading should give you a feel for his style and major themes. As you read, compare Wordsworth's poem to the selections you read last time. "Tintern Abbey" is written in blank verse (unrhymed iambic pentameter, or ten syllables per line). What other poets have you read that use blank verse? How is this different than Gray's "Elegy" you read last week, that had a very rigid structure?

∞ Link: Lines Composed a Few Miles above Tintern Abbey, On Revisiting the Banks of the Wye during a Tour. July 13, 1798

- What are some images that especially stand out to you? What is Wordsworth saying about nature?
- What do you think he means when he says in lines 64-67: "here I stand, not only with the sense / Of present pleasure, but with pleasing thoughts / That in this moment there is life and food / For future years."?

→ VIEW

Look at this painting of Tintern Abbey painted in 1804 by English landscape painter William Havell (1782-1857).

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 2

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 1

The Villanelle

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

This book introduces several poetic forms. Many of you will already know. However, some will be new, and there are still more that time won't allow us to cover. The anthology takes us further into the history of how those forms developed over the centuries, each new generation of poets dialoguing with those in the past. Along the way, you will read many different examples of each form, and you'll write your own poems as well.

→ READ

- p.xiii "This book" - "single poetic form."
- p.3-7 "Overview", "The Villanelle At-a-Glance", and "The History of the Form"

→ NARRATE

- Jot down a few ideas from your reading.
- Read "The House on the Hill" by Edwin Arlington Robinson on p.9-10. Then look at p.5, "The Villanelle At-a-Glance", and see if you can identify each of the poetic features listed in Robinson's poem. You may want to highlight, underline, or color-code the different features you find to help you notice and remember.

• COMPOSITION ACTIVITY

Over the year, you'll create your own reference book for the various poetic forms you study. The purpose is for you to have a quick guide that makes sense to you and is easy to pull up or keep on hand as you read individual poems. Start by creating your own "At-a-Glance" for the Villanelle. Here are a few of the possibilities:

- Copy the "Villanelle At-a-Glance" into a designated space in a notebook or a document on a device where you can easily find and reference it in the future. Add any additional notes for yourself that you'd like.
- Draw an illustration or create an infographic in Canva (or similar design software) showing the form more visually.
- Create a PowerPoint and create your own Villanelle At-a-Glance for the first slide (using text

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 1

		and/or visuals). ● Something else! Get creative!
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 2 <i>Reading Villanelles</i> Materials: The Making of a Poem, poetry notebook (opt.) → INTRO Refresh your memory with the "Villanelle At-a-Glance" on p.5 and read the following villanelles aloud. Think about the following questions as you read. You may want to keep your poetry notebook nearby or write in the margins of your book to track your thinking. ● What words strike you? ● What lines sound particularly odd? ● What reactions do you have as you read? ● Do all these poets follow the "rules" for villanelles, or do they bend them a bit? Playing with rules is part of the poet's business. Naturalist Jack Laws encourages us to view nature by asking ourselves, "What do I notice?", "What do I wonder?", and "What does this remind me of?" We can ask these same questions of stories and poems as well. Read these poems actively! Again, you may want to keep your poetry notebook nearby or write in the margins of your book to track your thinking as you read the next poems in this lesson. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.11-12 "The Waking," "One Art," and "Do Not Go Gentle into That Good Night" p.14 "By the Sound"	
WEEK 1	30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1	
WEEK 2	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2 <i>William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge</i> Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls; History of Lit PDF → RECAP What do you recall about the major themes of the Romantic Period from last week's reading? → INTRO Today we will learn more about the life and work of two poets - William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge, who are most closely associated with English Romantic poetry. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS 1. Marshall, Ch.LXXIV "Wordsworth - the Poet of Nature." ● How did Wordsworth's experiences as a child seem to influence his later poetry? 2. Marshall, Ch.LXXV "Wordsworth and Coleridge - the Lake Poets." ● What are some similarities and differences between the two poets?	● IMPORTANT DATES William Wordsworth (1770-1850) Samuel Taylor Coleridge (1772-1834) First publication of the Lyrical Ballads (1798)
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3 <i>William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge</i> → INTRO With the anonymous publication in 1798 of their Lyrical Ballads, Wordsworth and Coleridge introduced a new style of poetry to the public. The initial publication received mixed reviews, however, and with each	



Term 1

subsequent publication, the two poets included a Preface by way of an introduction to their style, themes, and purpose. In today's lesson, you will read excerpts from the 1802 edition of this preface, as well as a representative poem by each of them. Think about how the poetry you read illustrates some of the points made in the Preface.

→ READ & DISCUSS

1. ∞ PDF Link: Excerpts from the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads (1802)

2. Wordsworth, "My Heart Leaps Up"

My heart leaps up when I behold

A rainbow in the sky:

So was it when my life began;

So is it now I am a man;

So be it when I shall grow old,

Or let me die!

The Child is father of the Man;

And I could wish my days to be

Bound each to each by natural piety.

3. ∞ Link: Wordsworth, "I Wandered Lonely As A Cloud"

4. ∞ Link: Coleridge, "The Rime of the Ancient Mariner"

• NOTE: This poem is too long to read completely today, but reading it for a few minutes will give you a feel for the style. If you enjoy it, please finish reading it during the next poetry class or during your free reading time!

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 3

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Samuel Taylor Coleridge

→ INTRO

Today we are going to read a poem much different in style from The Rime of the Ancient Mariner. As you read, think about other poems you have read about children, or by poets remembering their own childhood.

∞ Link: Frost at Midnight

With any time remaining, you can read more of The Rime of the Ancient Mariner.

★ TEACHER TIP

There is a Poem Guide for Frost at Midnight at the Poetry Foundation link, if your student would like extra information about the poem or help with understanding it.

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 4

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 3

More Villanelles

📄 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ

p.18 "Villanelle for the Middle of the Night"

p.19-20 "Close-up of a Villanelle"

∞ Article Link: Villanelle by Andrew Lang

∞ Article Link: A Dainty Thing's the Villanelle by W.E. Henley

→ DISCUSS

- Which of the villanelles that you've read is your favorite? Why?
- The villanelle has been called the "poetry of loss" because of the way the repeated lines can build an echo of sadness. However, as you previously

• COMPOSITION

Start writing your own villanelle. Refer to your At-a-Glance guide and the villanelles you have read as needed.

Reference: Making of a Poem



Term 1

read, the villanelle originated from lighter ballads and songs and has also been used for lighter and happier topics (several of the ones you read today). What topics do you think the villanelle fits best?

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 4

The Sestina

Materials: The Making of a Poem, copies of poems (opt.)

→ INTRO

You'll read a variety of sestinas over the next few lessons. Sestinas are a pretty complicated poetic form (they show the poet/singer's mastery!), so it's ok if it takes a bit of time to make sense of the patterns. You may want to print off some of the poems or mark them up in your book to help you notice the various features of the genre (along with your other thoughts).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.21-24 "The Sestina At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context"

→ READ

Read the poem aloud to better hear the words since it is from the 1500s and the spelling is not the same as today (Edmund Spenser is a famous English poet from that time).

p.25-26 "Ye wastefull woodes, bear witness of my woe"

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

WEEK 3 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

Rabindranath Tagore

→ INTRO

If you are taking the Poetry Reading course this year, you will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher and artist Rabindranath Tagore. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century.

→ VIEW, NARRATE & DISCUSS

This video provides an excellent overview of Tagore's life and work. It will take nearly the entire lesson time to watch, although you can watch at 1.25x speed.

∞ Video Link: Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate

- What were some of Tagore's major contributions to arts and history?

→ READ

∞ Link: The Gardener 85

This short poem is a timely piece to read, since Tagore was still alive and writing a century ago.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Rabindranath Tagore (1861-1941)

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Rabindranath Tagore

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ INTRO

We will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher and artist Rabindranath Tagore, who was born in 1861 in Calcutta, India, and grew up in a family that loved art, music, and ideas. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a

★ TEACHER NOTE

If you are not taking the History of Lit 9-12 course, you may wish to watch this introduction to the life and work of Rabindranath Tagore during some free time.

∞ Video Link: Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate



Term 1

significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century. In 1913, he became the first non-European writer to be awarded the Nobel Prize for Literature. He also composed the national anthems for both India and Bangladesh, making his words a lasting part of two nations.

The Crescent Moon is a collection of forty poems exploring themes such as childhood wonder, the natural world, imagination. As you read through these poems, think about other poems you have read that present the world through the eyes of children, such as Robert Louis Stevenson's *A Child's Garden of Verses*.

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.6-7 "The Home"

- How would you describe the speaker of this poem?
- The poem opens with two examples of personification (a figure of speech which gives human characteristics to non-human things). Why do you think Tagore uses these images of a miser and a widow?

p.8 "On the Seashore"

- What images stand out most to you in this poem? How might they be symbols of a deeper meaning that lies beneath a simple description of children playing?

p.9-10 "The Source" and "Baby's Way"

- What do these two poems together seem to say about the nature of infants and children?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 5

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.11-16

p.12-13 "Sleep-Stealer"

- Do you think someone really stole the baby's sleep?
- What phrase is repeated throughout the poem? Why do you think this is?
- How does the poem blur the line between the real world and the imaginative world?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 6

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 5

Reading Sestinas

Materials: The Making of a Poem, digital or physical notebook

→ INTRO

Read the following poems aloud once to simply enjoy the sound of the words and get the sense of the poem. Then read the poems again, looking more closely at the formal features of the poetry (pay special attention to



Term 1

the last words of each line, and watch the pattern). Finally, write questions or thoughts in your book or notebook.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.29 "Sestina: Of the Lady Pietra degli Scrovigni (translation; the original is written in Italian by Dante Alighieri, who wrote the Divine Comedy)
p.30-31 "Sestina"

→ CREATE

Start creating your own "Sestina At-a-Glance" page for your reference guide in your digital or physical medium of choice.

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 6

More Sestinas

Materials: The Making of a Poem, digital or physical notebook used in the previous lesson

→ CREATE

Take a few minutes to finish creating your "Sestina At-a-Glance" page in your reference guide.

→ READ

p.32-35 "Sestina," "Sestina of the Tramp-Royal," and "Sestina: Altaforte"

(Note that part of the context for "Altaforte" is the poet imagining what a man known for stirring up strife might say. The man is based on a character in Dante's longer epic poem, the Divine Comedy, who was put in hell for stirring up strife).

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

How would you describe the energy and emotion in each of the poems from today?

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

WEEK 4 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Sir Walter Scott

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ INTRO

E.M. Forster described Sir Walter Scott as a writer "over whom we shall violently divide," and certainly he has had his share of ardent readers and detractors. But one reason his works are still appreciated, as the literary critic Walter Allen said, is that "without being in the strict sense an historian, he revolutionized the writing of history." Today we will learn more about this author whom Virginia Woolf described as "perhaps the last novelist to practice the great, the Shakespearean art, of making people reveal themselves in speech," and of whom Jane Austen said, "Walter Scott has no business to write novels, especially good ones. It is not fair. He has Fame and Profit enough as a Poet!"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXVII "Scott - The Awakening of Romance

Ch.LXXVIII "Scott - 'The Wizard of the North'"

- What elements of Scott's subject matter and style seem distinctive to you?

→ READ

∞ Link: Lochinvar

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 1

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.17-22

p. 19 "Playthings"

- How does the poem compare child's play to adult work, and which seems more satisfying?
- What "art" has the adult forgotten?
- What does the poem mean when it says adults spend their lives seeking "costly playthings"? Does this create success and happiness?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 7

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.23-29

p. 23-24 "Fairyland"

- Why do you think the child whispers the secret to the mother instead of telling everyone?
- In what ways can imagination transform ordinary places into something wondrous and special?

p. 28-29 "Paper Boats"

- What is inside the boat during the poem?
- What do you think the child imagines will happen to the paper boats on their journey?
- Why do you think the child hopes that "someone in some strange land" will find the boats?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ VIEW

∞ Picture Link: Tulsi plant

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 8

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 7

Sestinas Continued

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.38-40 "The Shrinking Lonesome Sestina" and "Nani"

• COMPOSITION

Start writing your own sestina. Refer to your At-a-Glance guide and the sestinas you have read as needed. Because sestinas are fairly long and the form is complicated, you may not be able



Term 1

∞ Article Link: Sestina by Elizabeth Bishop

- If you drew an illustration for each of these three poems, what would it be? Why?
- How do you imagine the speakers in "The Shrinking Lonesome Sestina" and "Nani"? Who are they?
- How do you think the title and shape (literal shape and length of lines) relate to the words of the poem in "The Shrinking Lonesome Sestina"?

to finish your poem during the allotted time. Try to write at least two stanzas during the lesson and finish the poem on your own time if you like.

Reference: Making of a Poem

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 8

The Pantoum

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.43-45 "The Pantoum At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," and "The Contemporary Context"

p.47 "Pantoum of the Great Depression"

p.49-51 "Pantoum" and "Grandmother's Song"

You'll notice that not all of the Pantoums follow the "rules," especially the rules for the rhyme scheme.

- How would you describe the effect of this form?
- Why do you think the poets chose to break the "rules"?
- Do you hear the "mesmerizing chain of echoes" in these poems?

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

WEEK 5 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Percy Bysshe Shelley

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Sir Walter Scott from last week?

→ INTRO

Today, we are turning our attention to the first of two second-generation Romantic poets: Percy Bysshe Shelley, wife of Mary Shelley (the author of *Frankenstein*). If you are also taking the Poetry course, you will read some of his poetry this week. However, today you will also read an excerpt from his *Defence of Poetry*, a philosophical essay on the nature and function of poets and poetry.

Do you recall any details about Shelley from the overview of the Romantic Period you read in Week 1?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: Percy Bysshe Shelley Biography

2. *Defence of Poetry*

- What are the main points Shelley is making in this excerpt? What images and arguments stand out to you the most? What do you think he means by "poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world?"

• COMPOSITION - Compare/Contrast

Compare and contrast what you read of Shelley's *Defence to the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads*.

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?



Term 1

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.30-35

p. 33-34 "The Merchant"

- What gifts would you bring home if you traveled to magical lands like the child in the poem?
- What do the different gifts chosen for the mother, father, and brother reveal about how the child sees each person?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ VIEW

∞ Picture Link: Shiuli flower (The English name is night-blooming jasmine.)

WEEK 5 📅 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 9

WEEK 5 📅 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Percy Bysshe Shelley

→ INTRO

Today, we are turning our attention to the first of two second-generation Romantic poets: Percy Bysshe Shelley. While he was inspired by the work and thought of Wordsworth and Coleridge, he has a style all his own. Look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The first two poems are sonnets: what do you already know about sonnets? How does the form support the meaning of the poem? Both these poems have guides, if you would like to read about them further.
 - ∞ Link: Ozymandias
 - ∞ Link: England in 1819
 - What do you know about what was happening in English around the year 1819?

2. In these second two poems, consider how Shelley is representing nature.

∞ Link: Ode to the West Wind

∞ Link: Mont Blanc

- What poetic images stand out to you the most?

WEEK 5 📅 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 10

WEEK 5 📅 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 9

Writing a Pantoum

📄 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ

∞ Article Link: I'm going to like it here (from Oscar and Hammerstein; a partial Pantoum)

→ WRITE

Write your own pantoum. Be sure to follow rule #3, but you can choose which of the other rules to keep or break as long as the poem still follows enough rules to be recognizable as a Pantoum.



Term 1

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 10

Introducing Sonnets

Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ INTRO

For the rest of the term and into next, we'll be focusing on sonnets and some particularly famous sonneteers such as Petrarch, Shakespeare, John Donne, George Herbert, and others.

→ CREATE

Spend 5-10 minutes creating an "at-a-glance" for a Pantoum for a reference guide.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.55-59 "The Sonnet At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context"

NOTE: In #3 on p.55, the authors have conflated (combined) a third sonnet form with the Petrarchan. Don't worry about the details, but you'll want to ignore #3 in your book and focus on the two most common rhyme schemes listed below.

- Petrarchan: octave rhyming abba abba, followed by a set usually rhyming cdcdcd or cdecde.
- Shakespearean sonnet: rhyme scheme abab cdcd efef gg

WEEK 5 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

WEEK 6 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Percy Bysshe Shelley from last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

This article is fairly long. You may skim through the information about her early life with Percy Shelley, but be sure to read the excerpts of her travel writing and other prose towards the end of the article.

∞ Article Link: Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley Biography

- What aspects of Mary Shelley's character are evident in her writing? If you are reading Frankenstein this year, does knowing more about the author's life affect your reading of her work?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Shelley that you read in the last lesson? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.36-40

p. 36 "Vocation"

- Why does the child think the hawker, gardener, and watchman have exciting lives?
- How does the poem contrast school life with the child's longing for independence?
- What does the poem suggest about our tendency to imagine that other lives are freer or happier than our own?



Term 1

p. 40 "Authorship"

- Did you catch the line about the child making a paper boat? Do you think this is the same child who made paper boats in a previous poem?
- What kinds of stories does the child wish the father would write?
- How does the poem show the difference between the way children and adults value work, play, and creativity?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 11

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

John Keats

→ INTRO

Today, we will meet the second of the second-generation Romantic poets: John Keats. As we did with Shelley, look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period. There is only one poem to read today, because your understanding and appreciation of it will increase with multiple readings. Read it through more than once on your own, and if you would like some interpretive help, there is a link to a Guide to the poem.

∞ Link: Poem Guide: Ode on a Grecian Urn

This poem, Ode on a Grecian Urn, is a famous example of ekphrasis, or the poetic descriptions of a work of art. As you read, think about how the poetry engages with other arts, such as sculpture and music. What does it have to say about the limits of any one art form, or, put more bluntly, what can poetry do that sculpture can't, and vice versa?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Ode on a Grecian Urn

- The final enigmatic two lines have been an interpretive puzzle since Keats wrote this poem - what do you think he means by "Beauty is truth, truth beauty,—that is all / Ye know on earth, and all ye need to know." And why are they in quotation marks?

→ VIEW

It is helpful to have an image of what Keats is describing when reading the poem.

∞ Link: Sketch of an Urn by Keats

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 12

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 11

Petrarch's Life & Poetry

→ INTRO

As a literature scholar explains, "Sonnet" comes from an Italian word meaning 'little song,' and that from a Latin word meaning 'sound.' Keep this in mind as you read.

→ READ & DISCUSS

After reading a brief bio, start reading some of Petrarch's sonnets. Read them aloud.

∞ Article Link: Petrarch Bio

∞ Article Link: Petrarch's Sonnets, Sonnet I, VI, VIII, X, XII, and XV

- Look more closely at one or two sonnets. Look at both the Italian and English versions. Can you see the rhyme pattern?

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

- Count the lines and find where the octave ends and the sestet begins. Can you see the shift, sometimes called the "volta", in the poem's tone or argument? What is it?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 12

More Petrarch

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pick a few other Petrarchan sonnets from a different translation to read.
∞ Article Link: More Petrarch Sonnets

- Look more closely at Sonnet XII. Based on the other sonnets you've read by Petrarch, what do you think about his claim that his far-off love, Laura, "points [him] to heaven"?

• COMPOSITION

Some have called Petrarch's Sonnets the 14th-century equivalent of pop songs today. Compare and contrast the two. Would you agree or disagree with this comparison?

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

John Keats

Materials: English Literature for Boys and Girls

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXXI "Keats - The Poet of Beauty"

- What are some connections between Keats and other writers you have studied this term? Which excerpts of his writing did you enjoy the most in today's reading?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.41-46

p. 49 "The Banyan Tree". The Banyan tree is the national tree of India.

- Why do you think the child wants to be the wind, a bird, or a duck?
- How does the poem show movement through the images?
- What might the child learn from quietly watching nature every day?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Parable of the Banyan Tree

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 13

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

John Keats, cont.

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Link: Ode to a Nightingale

- What does the nightingale represent to Keats in this poem?

• EXTRA HELPING

The Elgin Marbles are controversial, and Greece has requested their repatriation. Read more about the controversy here.

∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles



Term 1

2. The other two poems by Keats are both sonnets written in response to other works of art. The first he wrote after reading George Chapman's translation of Homer, and the second in response to the Elgin Marbles (statuaries from the Parthenon) when they first were displayed at the British Museum.

∞ Link: On First Looking into Chapman's Homer
∞ Link: On Seeing the Elgin Marbles

→ VIEW

A slide show of the sculptures that Keats would have seen.
∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles at the British Library

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 14

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 13

Shakespeare Wrote Sonnets

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ CREATE

Add an "At-a-glance" page to your reference guide for the Petrarchan Sonnet. Refer to p.55 "Sonnet At-a-Glance" and Lesson 10. You can combine your section on the Petrarchan sonnet with a section on Shakespearean sonnets, like our book does, or make two separate sections. Time will be allotted in other lessons to work on the details for the Shakespearean sonnet.

→ READ

p.59 "Shall I compare thee to a summer's day?"

In addition to his famous plays, Shakespeare is known for his sonnets--so much so that his name designates the unique form of the sonnet that became popular in England in the 16th century. If you have time remaining, pick a few sonnets to read for the rest of the lesson.

∞ Article Link: Shakespeare's Sonnets
Suggested: 8, 19, 23, 29, 55, 65, 73, 104, and 116

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 14

More Shakespearean Sonnets

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

Instead of an octave of eight lines and a set of six like the Petrarchan sonnet, Shakespearean sonnets have three quatrains (four lines each) and then a final rhyming couplet. You can see the rhyme scheme on p.55. Notice that each of the quatrains starts a new set of rhyming lines.

Pick a few new sonnets to enjoy today, and then spend several minutes observing one or two more closely (particularly their structure and rhymes).

∞ Article Link: Shakespeare's Sonnets
Suggested Sonnets: 8, 19, 23, 29, 55, 65, 73, 104, and 116

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7



Term 1

WEEK 8 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

→ INTRO

Today we will learn about a Romantic poet from another part of the world - Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda - who was born in Cuba and lived in Spain. She is the subject of *The Lightning Dreamer*, a biographical story told in poems, that you will begin to read this week if you are taking the Poetry Reading 9-12 course.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: [Biography of Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda](#)

- What aspects of her life made it difficult for her to be a poet? What aspects made it easier for her to be a poet than other women during this time period?
- The article describes her as "the epitome of the Romantic poet, the tragic heroine who rises to public acclaim yet, in private, is bitterly unhappy," which is a quotation from the preface to a 2001 edition of her novel *Sab*. Are there other Romantic poets you've learn about so far this term that you would describe the same way?
- What questions do you have about Avellaneda's life and work?

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: [10 Poems by Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda](#)

- What are your first impressions of her poetry? What subjects does she choose to write about?
- Do her poems remind you of anything else you've read?

• EXTRA HELPING

Listen to a recitation of "To a Butterfly"

∞ Video Link: [To A Butterfly by Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda](#)

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

📄 Materials: *Lightning Dreamer*

→ INTRO

Today we will begin a novel in verse about the Cuban-Spanish Romantic poet Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda (1814-1873) who used her writing to speak out against injustice of all kinds. If you have not read her biography already, it is linked below.

∞ Article Link: [Biography of Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda](#)

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.169-174 "Historical Note"

p.ix "Historical Background"

p.3-10 "Books are door-shaped" - "like oxen or mules."

- Who are the people? Make a character list. Each week as you read, think about the different perspectives of the poems and how each one sees the same situation very differently. Share your observations in your narrations.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other. Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 15

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

📄 Materials: *Lightning Dreamer*

→ RECAP

What were your first impressions of these poems?



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.11-24 "I feel like a new person" - "dark or light."

- How are the nuns able to support Tula?
- How did Tula's father influence her, and how has he death shaped who she is at thirteen?
- Continue to add to your character list.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other. Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 16

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 15

Sonnets 116 and 73

→ OBSERVE & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Shakespeare's Sonnets

Look at Sonnets 73 and 116 more closely.

- How many different word pictures can you find in the poems?
- Which ones stick out to you the most?
- Are any confusing?
- What kinds of emotions or thoughts do the images evoke?
- Describe the tone of the poems.
- Notice the rhyme scheme of the poems. Do they follow the Shakespearean form laid out in The Making of a Poem, p.55?
- Explain the first four lines of Sonnet 116 in your own words. What is Shakespeare saying about the nature of love? Do you agree?

Shakespearean sonnets are often written in iambic pentameter, which is a cadence natural to English. Choose either Sonnet 73 or 116 and count the syllables of each line, then read the poem aloud and listen for the stressed syllables.

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

The questions and activities in this lesson can be completed orally, in a group discussion, in writing, or even through sketches or other forms. Students should use whatever medium will best allow them to engage more deeply with these sonnets.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 16

Add to Your Reference Guide

Materials: your reference guide

→ CREATE

Add an at-a-glance section on the Shakespearean Sonnet to your reference guide, referring back to sonnets you've read, these lessons, and your book as desired.

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

José María Heredia

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda's life and poetry?

→ INTRO

As a child in Cuba, Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda was tutored by the Cuban Romantic poet José María Heredia. Today we will learn more about him and read two selections of his poetry. If you are reading The Lightning Dreamer, you will discover just how much an influence Heredia had on Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda's development as a writer and thinker.

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Biography of José María Heredia

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Niagara

∞ Link: The Hurricane

- How would you describe the mood of these poems?
- What does Niagara Falls and The Hurricane symbolize in these poems?
- Do these poems remind you of any others you have read this year?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you recall from

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.11-24 "I feel like a new person" - "dark or light."

- How are the nuns able to support Tula?
- How did Tula's father influence her, and how has he death shaped who she is at thirteen?
- Continue to add to your character list.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other. Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 17

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.47-50

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 18

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 17

John Donne's Holy Sonnets

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

John Donne lived during Shakespeare's time and took the sonnet form in a new direction as he built upon the tradition of both Petrarch and (what was coming to be known as) the Shakespearean sonnet. He was a poet and a priest, and instead of the flowing (and sometimes tearful) love poetry of Petrarch or Shakespeare, some of Donne's best-known sonnets are addressed to God rather than to a woman and contain unexpected rhythms and images. Pick a few sonnets to read aloud today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Suggested Sonnets: VII, X, XIV, XV, XIX

- How would you describe John Donne based on what you've read in these poems?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 18

More Donne

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Continue reading Donne's sonnets. Finish reading the suggested sonnets from the last lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets

Suggested Sonnets: VII, X, XIV, XV, XIX

- What lines do you think are most interesting or striking?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Benjamin Britten set some of Donne's sonnets to music!

∞ **Audio Link:** Britten's Holy Sonnets

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

WEEK 10 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Felicia Dorothea Hemans

→ RECAP

Which of the two poems by Heredia that you read last week did you prefer?

→ INTRO

We're jumping back in time by a few decades today to meet Felicia Dorothea Hemans, an English Romantic poet who was wildly popular in her own day. She was read and admired by many poets you have been reading so far this term.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Biography of Felicia Dorothea Hemans

- Writing allowed Hemans to provide for herself and her five sons after she was abandoned by her husband, but what were some ways that the challenges she faced negatively impacted her writing?
- Do you see any similarities in the biographies of Felicia Hemans and Mary Shelley?

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: To Wordsworth

∞ Link: The Haunted House

∞ Link: Casabianca

- How would you describe the style of these poems? Do they remind you of other works you've read so far this year?
- The poem Casabianca, with its tragic pathos, was a poem that almost took on a life of its own upon publication, being often imitated and (later on) parodied. What do you think it was about this poem that made it so popular?

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

Lightning Dreamer

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 19



Term 1

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.51-54

p. 54 "The Last Bargain"

- Why do you think the child chooses the child instead of the king, the old man, or the fair maiden?
- What do you think the speaker discovers about freedom by the end of the poem?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ LISTEN

Tagore's words became the basis for both India's and Bangladesh's national anthems. You can listen to them here with an English translation.

∞ Music Link: Jana Gana Mana - India National Anthem English lyrics

∞ Music Link: "Amar Shonar Bangla" - Bangladesh National Anthem Bangla & English lyrics

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 20

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 19

Sonnets VII and X

→ OBSERVE (ORALLY OR IN WRITING)

- What is the rhyme scheme of Sonnets VII and X? Note: think about the way the last two lines in Sonnet X might sound in a Shakespearean British accent.
- Count the syllables in each line of both sonnets and listen to the rhythm of the poems. What do you think the meter is? (answers in the Teacher Note in the next lesson)
- Based on what you know of Shakespearean & Petrarchan sonnets, which form would you say each of Donne's sonnets aligns with more closely? Why? Consider the rhyme scheme, the larger structure (octave+sestet versus three quatrains + couplet), and the content of the poem (where does the turn or "volta" happen in the poem's argument or theme?).

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 20

Sonnet XIV

→ INTRO

Sonnet XIV is one of Donne's most famous sonnets. We're going to spend a bit more time with it today. First, read the poem aloud and narrate, telling what you remember and notice about the images, meaning, or anything else about the poem. Then use the discussion activities to dive deeper.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets Sonnet XIV

- Look at the "formal features" of the poem. What is the rhyme scheme,

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE
Notes/Answers for Lesson 19

Sonnet VII rhyme scheme:

abbaabbacddcdee. The meter is pretty consistently iambic pentameter (typical for sonnets).

Sonnet X rhyme scheme:

abbaabbacddcdee (the meter is mostly iambic pentameter with some inconsistencies, but it's hard to hear it all because we don't pronounce or stress words quite the same as Donne did.



Term 1

meter, or structure (Shakespearean or Petrarchan)?

- Why might someone argue the sonnet is Shakespearean in structure? What is the evidence for a Petrarchan structure?
- What kinds of images or comparisons does Donne use in the poem? What do you think of them?
- Notice how Donne breaks the normal flow of a sonnet's iambic pentameter rhythm in the first four lines. Can you hear the "knocking" that Donne creates with the sounds of the words themselves in the lines "knock, breath, shine," and "break, blowe, burn"? Master poets often break the "rules" of a poetic form to add to their poem's effect and meaning. Whenever something is "wrong" in a poem or a book by a skilled writer, it is an invitation to ponder why, most likely, the rule was broken to show the sense of the words visually or acoustically.
- What do you think of the poem's overall effect and ideas?

WEEK 10 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

WEEK 11 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Thomas Carlyle

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the life and work of Felicia Hemans from last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXXII "Carlyle - The Sage of Chelsea"

- Marshall writes that Carlyle "was a great historian, but in the history he gives us not dead facts, but living, breathing men and women. His pages are as full of color and of life as the pages of Shakespeare." What history books have you read that could be described that way? Why is it such a praiseworthy feature of history writing?
- What do you notice about Carlyle's style in the passages quoted in today's reading?

- **COMPOSITION** - Descriptive
Write a character sketch of Thomas Carlyle based on Marshall's chapter.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

Catch-up

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 21

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22

Tagore - Fireflies

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 22

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 21

Serious Sonnets?

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Are you tired of sonnets? Sonnets are dense "little songs," packed with word-pictures that require us to pause and ponder. As you've seen, they are often written in praise of something or someone and can focus on weighty topics like aging, death, and love for God. And they've been around for hundreds of years now, so sometimes the words themselves are hard to understand! Maybe sonnets are your new favorite type of poem. But if they're not, hopefully you're gaining a little more appreciation for how complex they are and how much thought and talent went into each of them! Today, take a break from some of the harder, older sonnets we've been reading and enjoy more recent ones (some with lighter topics,

- ★ **TEACHER NOTE**
Notes/answers for lesson 20

The rhyming couplet at the end of the sonnet aligns with a typical Shakespearean structure, but the overall rhyme scheme and the shift in thought in the final six lines (notice how the sestet begins a new sentence and starts with the contrasting conjunction, "Yet.") align with a Petrarchan structure.



Term 1

too!).

→ READ & DISCUSS

Pick 2-3 to read and discuss.

p.61 "Composed Upon Westminster Bridge"

p.62 "Ozymandias"

p.65 "From the Dark Tower"

p.67-68 "A Game of Chess"

∞ Article Link: Funny Sonnets (read #1)

∞ Article Link: Poetry

→ DISCUSS

Sonnets are "little songs" and often love poems or poems in praise of a person, God, or something else. And they often present some sort of struggle or problem, and the resolution (remember the "volta" or turn?). If you were going to write a sonnet, what would it be about?

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 22

Writing a Sonnet

📄 Materials: your reference guide

→ WRITE

Begin writing your own sonnet. Keep your reference guide on hand. Here are a few tips to get started:

1. Choose a topic. Perhaps something from a book or something you've experienced. Funny or serious.
2. After you've chosen your topic, think of some different ways to describe it. You might write down "[your topic] is like ____" and try to fill in the blank to get your creative juices flowing.
3. Read and then write a few lines of iambic pentameter to get the rhythm in your head (you can write gibberish - the point is just to get the flow in your mind).
4. Now start putting it all together and write your sonnet. You may want to write a full 14 lines and then go back and change some of the words to get the meter right, adjust a metaphor, etc.

★ STUDENT NOTE

You may choose to continue working on their sonnet during composition time this week or just spend the lesson time working on it. The goal is not to have a finished "product" but to engage the sonnet form experientially and seek to communicate your own ideas through it.

WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

WEEK 12 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
History of Lit. Readings

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23

Exam

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 23

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24

Exam

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 24

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 1

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 23
Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 24
Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 2

WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Ralph Waldo Emerson

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

For the next few weeks, we will meet a selection of American writers and poets who were active in the mid-to-late nineteenth century, around the years 1840-1876. As an introduction, Long has a helpful overview of the characteristics of the literature written during this period.

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.#-# "We have noted the significant fact" - "consider an age of poetry."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: Biography of Ralph Waldo Emerson

- Do you recognize some of the names of writer who influenced Emerson and who admired him in turn?

2. Spend some time exploring poems written by Emerson, or read excerpts from his famous essay "Self-Reliance" (you probably won't have time to read the whole thing during this lesson time, but you could come back to it later).

∞ Link: Poems by Emerson

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF #-#

- What does non-conformity mean to Emerson? How does he describe it?
- What does Emerson mean by "Trust thyself: every heart vibrates to that iron string"?
- How would you describe Emerson's language and imagery in "Self-Reliance"? What does it remind you of?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

• **IMPORTANT DATES**
Virgil (70BC - 19BC)

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 25

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 26

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 25

Introducing Ballads

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Storytelling is common in every culture, and before the invention of the printing press, songs, stories, and fables were passed on orally from culture to culture and through the generations. As they traveled, storytellers developed their versions of the tale, adding or adjusting the narrative, the tune, or the verses of the song. The ballad is one form of storytelling with a long tradition, and it became a particular poetic form in English.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-78 "The Ballad At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context"

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Learn more about the history of ballads in North America.

∞ **Article Link:** LOC Ballads

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- Do you know any ballads or ballad-like poems/songs (new or old)? Name them and tell why they fit into the ballad genre as described in your book.

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 26

Reading Ballads

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.78-83 "The Cherry-tree Carol (early 1400s)," "Sir Patrick Spens," "The Wife of Usher's Well," and "My Boy Willie"

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Listen to a different version of the Wife of Usher's Well.

∞ Article Link: The Wife of Usher's Well

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

WEEK 2 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

Henry David Thoreau

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What stood out most to you reading about Emerson last week?

→ INTRO

Another Transcendentalist writer who was strongly influenced by Emerson was Henry David Thoreau. As you read today, see if you recognize similar themes and concepts from what you read last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: Biography of Henry David Thoreau

2. "Solitude" from Walden

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF #-#

- How does Thoreau differentiate between being alone and loneliness? Why, according to him, can people be lonely even when they are with others?

- What does this reading tell us about how Thoreau relates to nature?

- Which aspects of Thoreau's views on solitude are most relevant today?

Do you think that modern society still values solitude? What has perhaps made it harder to be alone in the way Thoreau describes?

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 27

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 28

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 27

Historical Ballads

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Listen to a few more ballads. Although not all folk songs are ballads, older ballads almost always are folk songs (newer ballads were often composed as poems rather than songs). Listen to 3-4.

∞ Video Link: The Water of Tyne (1364)

∞ Video Link: There Were Three Ravens (published 1611)

∞ Video Link: Corpus Christi Carol (early 1500s)

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 2

- ∞ Video Link: Frog Went a Courting (first mentioned in 1548, though this version has evolved from then)
- ∞ Video Link: Scarborough Fair (mid 1600s)

WEEK 2 □ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 28

Reflecting on Ballads

□ Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ REFLECT

Orally or in writing, reflect for about 10 minutes on the ballads from the last two lessons (you may want to reread or rewatch a few). What are the similarities and differences you notice? If you were an alien who knew nothing about the world and all you had were these ballads, what would you think about our world? Describe it to a fellow alien.

→ CREATE

Add a "Ballad-at-a-Glance" section to your reference guide. Refer to p.73.

WEEK 2 □ 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

WEEK 3 □ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Walt Whitman

Walt Whitman Revolutionised American Poetry

WEEK 3 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

WEEK 3 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 29

WEEK 3 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30

WEEK 3 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 30

WEEK 3 □ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 29

Recent Ballads

□ Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

Enjoy these more recent ballads. Notice how the content is similar and/or different from the older ballads.

p.88-90 "Peter and John"

p.92-94 "Tale of Custard the Dragon"

p.94-98 "Riverbend Blues" and "Ballad of John Cable and Three Gentlemen"

∞ Video Link: Wreck of the Edmund Fitzgerald

WEEK 3 □ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 30

Writing a Ballad

□ Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Write your own ballad and read (or sing!) it to someone.

WEEK 3 □ 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

WEEK 4 □ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Emily Dickinson

WEEK 4 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31

Literature: Grade 9

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scan the [QR code](#)
for links.



Term 2

WEEK 4	30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 31	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32	
WEEK 4	30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 32	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 31 <i>Blank Verse</i> Materials: The Making of a Poem → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.101-105 "Blank Verse At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context," and Henry Howard's excerpt from the Aeneid. Read Henry Howard's lines aloud (assume they are iambic and read the stresses that way).	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 32 <i>Older Examples of Blank Verse</i> Materials: The Making of a Poem → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.105-110 "What is beauty" - "of the whole"	• EXTRA HELPINGS Look for examples of blank verse in Shakespeare's plays!
WEEK 4	30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16	
WEEK 5	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17	
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33	
WEEK 5	30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 33	
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34	
WEEK 5	30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 34	
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 33 <i>More Recent Blank Verse</i> Materials: The Making of a Poem → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.110-118 "Ulysses" - "Stanzas in Bloomsbury"	• COMPOSITION Write a narration (or pick a previous narration to rewrite) in blank verse.
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 34 <i>Heroic Couplet</i> Materials: The Making of a Poem, reference guide → CREATE Add an "at-a-glance" section for Blank Verse to your reference guide. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.121-123 "The Heroic Couplet At-a-Glance," and "The History of the Form"	
WEEK 5	30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17	



Term 2

WEEK 6 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

The Victorian Period

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

The close of the Romantic Period is commonly marked by the death of Sir Walter Scott in 1832, and the remainder of the nineteenth-century in British Literature is referred to as the Victorian Period, named for Queen Victoria who reigned from 1837-1901. Literature written during this period often focused on social issues, the changes wrought by the Industrial Revolution, effects of new discoveries in science and a concern for morality. This was also the period that saw the rise in popularity of the novel.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: History of Lit PDF "The Victorian Period" p.#-#

- Where do you see elements and concerns of the Victorian Period still present in our culture today?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 35

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 36

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 35

Chaucer: The Beginning of Heroic Couplets

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Canterbury Tales, General Prologue

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 36

Reading Heroic Couplets

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.123-127 "from the Description of Cooke-ham" - "from the Vanity of Human Wishes"

- Use heroic couplets to narrate your impressions of one of the poems you read.

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 37

The Aeneid - Introduction

Materials: The Aeneid

→ INTRO

What do you know about an "epic" – what are the connotations of the word more broadly, and what do you know about epics in literature? Name any you have read and what you remember about epic conventions.

Virgil's Aeneid is an epic that owes much to Homer's two books, The Iliad and the Odyssey, which you may have already read in part or as a

- COMPOSITION - Compare/Contrast Compare The Aeneid's opening Invocation to the Muse (lines 1-13) to the openings of The Iliad and The Odyssey.
- ∞ PDF Link: Iliad Opening Lines
- ∞ PDF Link: Odyssey Opening Lines
- How is Virgil both imitating Homer and also doing something very new?



Term 2

retelling. Chronologically, the story of The Aeneid picks up where the Iliad left off - with the fall of Troy - but Virgil lived 700-800 years after Homer, in a very different world. During Virgil's lifetime, the Roman Republic was coming to an - at times violent - end, and amid this uncertainty, Virgil looked backwards and chose the founding of Rome as his epic subject: following the Trojan Aeneas from the destruction of Troy to the founding of a new city.

C.S. Lewis, in his Preface to Paradise Lost, saw epics like the Iliad, the Odyssey, and Beowulf, as "Primary Epics": they are works written down after a long tradition of oral storytelling, and tell the story of heroic deeds in order that such deeds may be remembered. They are myth-making stories, far more concerned with the life of one hero - Achilles, Odysseus, Beowulf - than with the wider historical context.

However, Lewis argues that something new happens with Virgil, and the Aeneid is the earliest example of a "Secondary Epic": "one of the most important revolutions in the history of poetry." In The Aeneid, Lewis writes, Virgil "decides to take one single national legend and treat it in such a way that we feel the vaster theme to be somehow implicit in it. He has to tell a comparatively short story and give us the illusion of having lived through a great space of time. He has to deal with a limited number of personages and make us feel as if national, or almost cosmic, issues are involved. He must locate his action in a legendary past and yet make us feel the present, and the intervening centuries, already foreshadowed."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. This helpful introduction to the Aeneid should give you a clear overview of the context of the epic and the general plot before we dive into the poem itself. You can read some of it today (skip the three exercises), or refer to it as you are reading the poem if you feel stuck.

∞ Link: Introduction to Virgil's Aeneid

2. Book 1, lines 1-96 "Wars and a man I sing" - "King of Cloudbursts."

- Today is a short reading to allow you time to look up characters in the Pronouncing Glossary (p.424-484) and begin to make a character list, if you would find that helpful.

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 37

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 38

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading? How does Virgil open his epic?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 97-367 "With such thanks" - "the men of Troy."

- What have you learned so far about the Aeneas's character? Why do you think he "assumes a look of hope / and keeps his anguish buried in his heart?"

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 38

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 37

More Heroic Couplets

Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.127-130 "To S.M." - "From an Essay on Criticism"



Term 2

→ CREATE Add an at-a-glance page on heroic couplets to your reference guide.	
WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 38 <i>The Stanza</i> Materials: The Making of a Poem → INTRO What comes to your mind at the word "stanza"? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.136-142 "The Stanza At-a-Glance," - "from The Faerie Queene" (be sure to read Chaucer and Spenser's poems aloud) Why do the authors argue that the stanza is the "opposite of blank verse"?	
WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19	
WEEK 8 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20	
WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 39 <i>The Aeneid, cont.</i> Materials: The Aeneid → RECAP What do you recall from the last reading? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Book 1, lines 367-595 "But Aeneas, duty-bound" - "who dares to battle men." - What have you learned so far about the gods? How do they interact with mortals? - Why do you think Venus comes to Aeneas in disguise? - Why does Aeneas have such an emotional reaction when he sees images of the Trojan War displayed in Carthage? → CLOSE READING 517-528: This is an example of an epic simile, which is an extended comparison. Here Virgil compares workmen making a theater to the labor of bees. Why is this a striking comparison?	COMPOSITION - Descriptive Try writing your own epic simile. It can be in prose or verse.
WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 39	
WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 40 <i>The Aeneid, cont.</i> Materials: The Aeneid → RECAP What do you recall from the last reading? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Book 1, lines 596-908 "And now / As Trojan Aeneas" - "and seas on earth." - Why does Venus send Cupid disguised as Ascanius? Do you think Venus is trying to protect Aeneas, manipulate the situation, or both? - Is Dido responsible for her eventual feelings for Aeneas if the gods interfere so heavily? What early signs in this passage hint that the	★ TEACHER NOTE Aeneas's son is called both Ascanius and Iulus.



Term 2

relationship between Dido and Aeneas may become tragic?
 • How much free will do mortals seem to have in the epic? This is a question to come back to as you read further.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 40

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 39 George Herbert

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

George Herbert was a master of using stanzas in a variety of different ways. He was also a sonneteer and a poet-priest, like John Donne, in the late 16th and early 17th century.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.143 "Easter Wings"

∞ Article Link: The Altar

∞ Article Link: The Pulley

∞ Article Link: Prayer (I)

∞ Article Link: Redemption

• Consider how George Herbert uses poetic features to show an aspect of the poem's meaning. For instance, in the poem "The Pulley", look at how the line, "rest in the bottom lay," is at the bottom of the stanza. What other examples can you find?

• Where is the "turn" or volta in Herbert's sonnet "Prayer (I)"?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Pay attention to the stanzas you're reading in Fierce Wars and Faithful Loves in your Poetry Reading lessons!

Also, consider incorporating some of Herbert's poetry into your devotional life.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 40 Reading Stanzas

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.143-147 "The Tyger," - "A Quoi Bon Dire"

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 41 The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 1-255 "Silence. All fell hushed" - "nor all the thousand ships."

• Have you heard the phrase "beware the Greeks bearing gifts" before? Why do you think it has become an adage?

• Why do you think Virgil chooses to recount the fall of Troy through the narrative of Aeneas rather than directly? How do you see Aeneas's emotion shaping the story he tells?

• What role does Sinon play in this section?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 41

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 42

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 2

WEEK 9 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 42**

WEEK 9 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 41**
More Stanzas

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ **READ & DISCUSS**

p.148-149 "The Tropics in New York" and "Night Song at Amalfi"
p.150-151 "Those Winter Sundays" and "Yes"

★ **TEACHER NOTE**
Sensitive Word in "Yes."

WEEK 9 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 42**

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem and your reference guide

→ **CREATE**

Add a stanza-at-a-glance section to your reference guide.

→ **WRITE**

Look/think back over the different types of stanzas you've seen. Then write a poem about something that you read about in school or experienced in life, choosing a particular way of using stanzas that will add meaning to your poem. Add a note at the end of your poem explaining why you used stanzas the way you did.

WEEK 9 📅 **30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21**

WEEK 10 📅 **30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22**

WEEK 10 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 43**
The Aeneid, cont.

📖 Materials: The Aeneid

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Book 2, lines 256-501 "But a new portent" - "they know so well."

- Can you find epic similes in this section? Why do you think there are so many of them in battle scenes?
- What is the significance of Aeneas dreaming of Hector's ghost? What message does Hector have for Aeneas?
- Why does Aeneas keep fighting even once it is clear that Troy is lost?

WEEK 10 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 43**

WEEK 10 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 44**

WEEK 10 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 44**

WEEK 10 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 43**
Meter At-a-Glance

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem, reference guide (opt.)

→ **READ**

p.159-160 "Types of Meter" and "the Character of Different Types of Meter"

→ **DISCUSS**

The overview of the meter is a bit dense, so let's make it more concrete.

★ **TEACHER/STUDENT TIP**

If you find it hard to think of examples for the lesson assignment, here are a few to get you started.

Accentual: Beowulf; Ba Ba Black Sheep

Syllabic: Think of Haikus you've read



Term 2

• Look back over poems in these lessons and jot down a few other poems or songs you know. Make a list with examples of accentual metered poems, syllabic metered poems, and accentual-syllabic metered poems. • You may want to turn this section into a new part of your reference guide as well. • Why might a poet choose to use one form versus another?	Accentual-syllabic: Many sonnets
WEEK 10 📅 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 44 📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide → READ p.160 → NARRATE • Write your own examples for each of the "feet" described. • These definitions lend themselves to visual representation. Create an infographic (by hand or digitally) describing the different "feet" in poetry to add to your reference guide.	
WEEK 10 📅 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22	
WEEK 11 📅 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23	
WEEK 11 📅 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 45 <i>The Aeneid, cont.</i> 📖 Materials: The Aeneid → RECAP What do you recall from the last reading? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Book 2, lines 501-725 "But oh / how wrong to rely" - "bow to my commands." • Why is Priam's death such a turning point in the fall of Troy? What details does Virgil include to make it particularly tragic? • What is Aeneas's reaction to Priam's death? • Why does Venus appear at that moment, and what is her message to Aeneas?	
WEEK 11 📅 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 45	
WEEK 11 📅 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 46 <i>Tennyson</i>	
WEEK 11 📅 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 46	
WEEK 11 📅 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 45 📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem → WRITE Refer to p.160 and write a few lines about something from your books or life, and use iambs as the main meter throughout the poem. Then write a few lines about the same topic using trochees. How did it change the feel of the poem?	★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP You may find it helpful to review examples of iambic and trochaic lines before writing to get the rhythm in your head. Iambic examples: many sonnets. Trochaic example: Tyger Tyger by William Blake (p.143), especially the first two lines.

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 2

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 46

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Refer to p.160 and write a few lines about something from your books or in your life, and use dactyls as the main meter throughout the poem. Then write a few lines about the same topic using anapests. How did it change the feel of the poem?

Bonus idea: If you want to challenge yourself, try adding a spondee into one of your poems as well.

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

You may find it helpful to review examples of dactylic and anapestic lines before writing to get the rhythm in your head.

Dactylic example:

∞ Article Link: The Charge of the Light Brigade

Anapestic example:

∞ Article Link: The Destruction of Sennacherib

WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23

WEEK 12 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 47

Exam

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 47

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 48

Exam

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 48

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 47

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 48

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

Mark Twain

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

You many have already come across Mark Twain and his influence in other literature courses this year. The twentieth-century novelist Ernest Hemingway claimed that "All modern American literature comes from one book by Mark Twain called Huckleberry Finn." What do you already know about Mark Twain and what have you read?

Today we will learn more about Twain through his life, his influence worldwide, and through reading a short story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Twain's Biography

∞ Article Link: Biography - Mark Twain

∞ Video Link: Mark Twain - Writer

2. Twain's Influence

∞ Article Link: Mark Twain and World Literature

• Which examples cited in this article were most surprising to you?

3. "Luck" by Mark Twain

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF #-#

• Where do you find irony in this story? Was it what you expected it would be?

• How reliable is the clergyman as a storyteller?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 49

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 725-998 "There / yes, where you see" - "headed toward the mountains."

• Venus shows Aeneas the actions of the gods in the fall of Troy - what does this say about fate and human action?

• Is Aeneas at fault for what happens to Creusa? Why or why not? How is your answer affected by her ghost's final speech?

• Book II ends with Aeneas carrying his father and leading his son. How is this symbolic for the past of Troy and the future of Rome?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 49

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 50

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ INTRO

Book 3 begins with Aeneas and his companions escaping from the destruction of Troy and beginning their arduous journey westward to Italy. They encounter several challenges and false starts along the way. Eventually, Aeneas hears that the Trojan Helenus, who has married



Term 3

Hector's widow Andromache, has settled in Buthrotum, and that is where our reading for today resumes.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 3, lines 350-592 "Here an incredible story" - "challenge all our children."

- Helenus, son of Priam and a seer, and Andromache are both characters from the Iliad. Why is it significant that Aeneas meets them at this point, and what prophecy does Helenus offer Aeneas?
- How is Buthrotum described? Is it familiar to Aeneas? Why does he choose to move on rather than stay and settle in a "miniature Troy"?
- In this section, does Aeneas seem more like a warrior, a leader, or a pilgrim guided by fate?

→ VIEW

The following map is a helpful guide as you read about Aeneas's journey:
∞ Map Link: Map of the Voyage of Aeneas and the Mythic Origins of Rome

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 50

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 49

Shaping Forms

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Stop to narrate after reading each section.
p.165-171 "Overview" "The Elegy-Overview," "Lament for the Makaris"

- Discuss this quote: "If metrical forms are the architecture of poetry, then the shaping forms of ode, elegy, and pastoral are its environment" (p.165)

• TERMINOLOGY

"Timor Mortis conturbat me" is Latin for "The fear of death disturbs me."

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 50

Reading Elegies

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Orally or in writing, reflect for about 5 minutes on the role of the poet and poetry today. Is poetry a part of public or popular life? Where and when? What types of poetry do you hear most frequently?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.171-178 "If Ever Hapless Woman Had a Cause" - "Lycidas"

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

WEEK 2 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 51

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ INTRO

Paul Lawrence Dunbar was one of the first Black Americans to earn a living as a writer and he inspired many other literary giants that would come after him. In fact, "I know why the caged bird sings" (one of the most iconic lines in African American literature and the title of Maya Angelo's autobiography) comes from one of Dunbar's poems. He was the only Black student in his high school, and became friends with Orville Wright and his brother Wilbur (who you may remember as the inventors of the airplane). The Wright brothers owned a printing press and published Dunbar's first

• EXTRA HELPING

For more on Paul Laurence Dunbar, you can read his full biography here:
∞ Link: Paul Laurence Dunbar bio



Term 3

writings. While Dunbar only lived to age 33, he has been described as "your favorite poet's favorite poet" due to the impact his large body of work had on future writers. Older students may want to read more about Dunbar in extra helpings.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.103-104 "Author's Note"

p. 1-10 "You never heard of" - "could try again."

- Why do you think the book says "it's almost like two different men wrote those two poems"? What are some of the differences both in form and content?

- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Fifth Massachusetts Colored Calvary

WEEK 2 📅 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 51

WEEK 2 📅 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 52

The Aeneid, cont.

📄 Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ INTRO

Book 3 begins with Aeneas and his companions escaping from the destruction of Troy and beginning their arduous journey westward to Italy. They encounter several challenges and false starts along the way. Eventually, Aeneas hears that the Trojan Helenus, who has married Hector's widow Andromache, has settled in Buthrotum, and that is where our reading for today resumes.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 3, lines 350-592 "Here an incredible story" - "challenge all our children."

- Helenus, son of Priam and a seer, and Andromache are both characters from the Iliad. Why is it significant that Aeneas meets them at this point, and what prophecy does Helenus offer Aeneas?
- How is Buthrotum described? Is it familiar to Aeneas? Why does he choose to move on rather than stay and settle in a "miniature Troy"?
- In this section, does Aeneas seem more like a warrior, a leader, or a pilgrim guided by fate?

→ VIEW

The following map is a helpful guide as you read about Aeneas's journey:
∞ Map Link: Map of the Voyage of Aeneas and the Mythic Origins of Rome

WEEK 2 📅 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 52

WEEK 2 📅 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 51

Here Follow Some Verses

📄 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ RECAP

Describe an elegy.

→ INTRO

Anne Bradstreet is a famous American poet. She was a master of meter

• COMPOSITION

Rewrite Anne Bradstreet's poem as a one-act play.



Term 3

and form. We're spending today on a poem she wrote after her house burned down. Be sure to read the poem aloud.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.178-180 "Here Follows Some Verses"

- Discuss this poem using naturalist Jack Laws' questions: What do you notice about this poem (including formal features)? What does it make you wonder? What does it remind you of? Look up words you don't know. Underline lines that stick out to you. Write questions or reactions.

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 52

More Elegies

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.180-190 "Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard" - "In Memory of W.B. Yeats"

- Of what you read today, which poem or poet would you most like to learn more about? Why?

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26

WEEK 3 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 53

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul Dunbar's family from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-16 "Little brown baby" - "Come in hyeah, you scamp!"

p.108-110 "Joshua Dunbar" - "for their beauty, as well."

p.17-20 "Matilda Dunbar loved" - "an' say good night."

- Paul Dunbar is acclaimed by literary historians for his innovation and experimentation. Where do you see evidence of that in the poems you are reading?
- Look closely at "When de Co'n Pone's Hot" (p.13-14): can you identify the meter (syllables per line) and a regular rhyme scheme? Is there a pattern? For an even bigger challenge, see if you can identify which syllables in each line are stressed (have more emphasis when you pronounce them). Is this regular, too?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 53

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 54

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ INTRO

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 3

After Aeneas leaves Buthrotum, he and his men sail near the land of the Cyclopes and rescue Achaemenides, a Greek who was left behind after Odysseus escaped the Cyclopes Polyphemus in The Odyssey. They then reach Sicily, where Aeneas's father dies, presumably of old age (3.818-829). We will pick up the story again with Book 4.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 1-247 "But the Queen" - "piling fuel on his fire."

- How much of what happens in this section is individual choice, and how much is fate controlled by the gods?
- What do you think of Anna's advice?
- Where do you see foreshadowing of tragedy in the way the love story is described?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 54

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 53

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

You do not have to read all the poems in this section. Pick ones that interest you most. Notice all the different structures and formal features (meter, rhyme, etc) that poets employ for these elegies.
p.191-206 "The Quaker in Nantucket" - "The Song"

- If you were to write an elegy, what would you write it about?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 54

Writing an Elegy

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Start writing your own elegy. Add a note on why you chose the particular "architecture" (meter, rhyme, etc.) for your poem.

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

WEEK 4 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 55

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul Dunbar's family from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.20-28 "Now, school" - "had made it possible."
p.110-111 "Central High School" - "Ohio Historical Society, Columbus."
p.29-31 "When Paul commenced" - "Who fought for Uncle Sam."

- Why do you think Dunbar chose not to write in dialect when composing "The Colored Soldiers"?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 55

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 3

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 56

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the opening of Book 4?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 248-494 "Iarbas - son of an African nymph" - "down upon her bed."

- How does Virgil describe Rumor? What makes Rumor such a powerful force in society and politics?
- What causes Aeneas to decide to leave Carthage?
- Do Dido and Aeneas seem to understand their relationship in the same way when they have their final conversation?
- If you have read the Odyssey, do you see a parallel in Odysseus's journey with Aeneas's time in Carthage?

★ TEACHER TIP

Sensitive content: preview the opening of today's reading, Book 4, line 248.

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 56

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 55

The Pastoral

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.207-212 "The Passionate Shepherd to His Love" - "The Garden"

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 56

Reading Pastorals

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ RECAP

Orally or in writing, describe some of the key themes in a pastoral.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.213- 219 "To My Sister" - "Lying in a Hammock"

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

WEEK 5 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 57

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul's time in school from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-40 "Door after door closed" - "likely just the way it was."

p.111-112 "The Western Association of Writers" - "ghosts and goblins."

- What images in "Sympathy" stood out to you the most? Does it remind you of anything else you've read this year?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language

• EXTRA HELPING

Listen to the poet and author Maya Angelou recite Sympathy.

∞ **Video Link:** Maya Angelou recites Sympathy

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 3

and cadence.

Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 57

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 58

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 494-653 "But Aeneas / is driven by duty" - "Dido says her prayers."

- How many of Aeneas's choices are his own, and how many are dictated by fate and the gods?
- Why does Dido decide that death is her only option?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 58

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 57

More Pastorals

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.223-226 "Fog" - "Smoke"

p.227-232 "From the Porch" - Tornadoes"

- Orally or in writing, discuss one of the poems you read. What stood out to you? What made you confused, intrigued, and/or shocked?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 58

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

This last pastoral we'll read is by a more recent poet, Mary Oliver, who has continued celebrating the beauty of nature.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.235 "The Black Walnut Tree"

∞ Article Link: Starlings in Winter

∞ Article Link: Invitation

∞ Article Link: The Summer Day

Would you consider these poems pastorals? Why or why not?

WEEK 5 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

WEEK 6 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 59

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.41-48 "I don't suppose" - "but who could he share them with?"

- Does the language and style of "The Unsung Hero" remind you of anything else you've read? What images stand out to you the most?
 - Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.
- Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 59

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 60

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 653-876 "The dead of night" - "dissolved in the winds."

- How are Dido's and Aeneas's actions contrasted with each other's in this section?
- What details does Virgil include that heighten the tragedy of Dido's death?
- Why does Juno send Iris to Dido?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 60

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 59

Writing a Pastoral

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Begin writing your own pastoral and then read it to someone. Add a note about why you used the "architecture" (meter, rhyme, etc.) that you did.

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 60

The Ode

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.240-246 "Overview" - "The Fire of Driftwood"

- Discuss how each of the poems you read fits the definition of an ode (or not).

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31



Term 3

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 61

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48-56 "But I don't want you to think" - "how deep you dig."

p.112-113 "It would be a shame" - "border of the United States."

p.57-60 "Chicago was behind Paul" - "nuffin' in de pot."

- Why do you think this poem is called a sermon? What is the message of the sermon?
- What does the author mean when she says "Studying a poem isn't like solving a problem in math"?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 61

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 62

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

In Book 5, Aeneas and the other Trojans leave Carthage and return again to Sicily. There they decide to hold funeral games - including races, boxing, and archery - to honour Aeneas's father Anchises. While the games are going on, the Trojan Women decide to try and burn the ships so that their journey will end there, but Jupiter sends rain to put out the flames. Aeneas is encouraged by the ghost of his father to continue his journey, but those who no longer want to join him are given the option to stay with King Acestes in Sicily.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 6, lines 1-248 "So as he speaks in tears" - "into the vatic Sibyl's shrine."

- How is the Sibyl of Cumae both a prophet and a warning figure? What does she reveal to him about his future?
- Why does Aeneas want to go to the Underworld? What does the Sibyl tell him?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 62

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 61

Reading Odes

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.248-255 "The Paper Nautilus" - "Perhaps the World Ends Here"

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 3

Pick one poem to observe more closely.

- Discuss what you notice about the images, meter, and rhyme.
- Why do you think the authors of the anthology considered it an ode?
- What are some of the ideas you notice in the poem?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 62

Perhaps the World Ends Here

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ LISTEN

Let's spend a little more time with an ode you read last week.

Read p.254-255

∞ Video Link: Perhaps the World Ends Here

→ DISCUSS

Reflect on the images in the poem. Why does the "world begin at the kitchen table"? What does the kitchen table symbolize or mean to you?

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31

WEEK 8 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 63

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-66 "It was time for another book" - "in a broken tongue."

p.114 "In the 1800s" - "member of the family."

p.67-69 "I suppose by now" - "you are welcome, welcome."

- The author writes "Seems to me that when he started putting together his second book, Paul must have been listening to his heart and his head both." Which qualities of his poetry do you think come from his heart, and which ones from his head?

- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once.

Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.

Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

• COMPOSITION

How did the hardships of Dunbar's childhood shape him as a writer and a person? Why do you think those same difficulties became a source of strength rather than holding him back?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 63

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 64

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

Our reading picks up today once Aeneas has entered the Underworld and seen a number of people whom he knew.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 6, lines 521-554 "And wandering among them" - "pities her as she passes."

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 3

- Why do you think Dido does not speak to Aeneas? Who does he blame for her death?

2. Book 6, lines 786-1039 "Now father Anchises" - "the sterns line the shore."

- What does Aeneas's father Anchises show to him? Why is this a significant turning point halfway through the epic?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 64

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 63

Writing an Ode

→ WRITE

Compose your own ode.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 64

Open Forms

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.259 "Overview"

→ READ & DISCUSS

In addition to its identity as an "open form," Prufrock is a wonderful example of how poems require "associative thinking." All poems, but especially some like Prufrock, require you to approach them like a painting. Only after you have observed the whole can you start to think about the ideas and emotions it describes. As you read and listen to the poem, let the words roll over you and let your mind drift with them. Listen to the sounds of the lines, the images described (some of them startling!), and notice the emotions the poem evokes. Do you feel frustrated as you read? Perhaps the poem INTENDS to make you feel frustrated!

p.262 "The Love Song of J. Alfred Prufrock"

- What images most strike you? What lines are most confusing? If this poem were a color, what color would it be? Why?
- Have you felt any of the emotions the speaker describes? Maybe you, too, have felt like you were "pinned and wriggling on a wall" when someone spoke to you.
- If you were going to draw an illustration to accompany this poem, what would it be?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Listen to the author read his own poem

∞ **Video Link:** The Love Song of J. Alfred Prufrock

• ILLUSTRATE

Draw or paint your own illustration of the poem!

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 65

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.69-78 "Majors and Minors" - "a brave man to voice it."

p.114-115 "When Alice's answering letter" - "by Jerome Dowd."

- Why do you think Dunbar chose the tree to recount the story of the



Term 3

murder?

- What are some of the other poems you have read so far by Paul Dunbar that seem to be addressing the racism and inequality described in today's reading?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 65

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 66

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

We are skipping Book 7 because of time constraints, but in the remaining readings from the Aeneid, you will notice a change of subject matter and style. If the first six books mirror the events of the Odyssey, the final six books mirror the events of the Iliad, with its martial theme.

In Book 7, Aeneas and the Trojans finally arrived in the Italian lands they have been promised by fate. They meet King Latinus, who believes fate has chosen Aeneas to marry his daughter Lavinia, but Juno's fury sets in motion a chain of events that destroys this early peace and sets the stage for war.

Our reading today picks up partway through Book 8, after Aeneas has made an alliance with King Evander, whose son Pallas leads an army to give Aeneas assistance.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 8, lines 717-858 "But the goddess Venus" - "all his children's children."

- What images does Vulcan forge onto the surface of the shield? Why are they significant at this point in the epic? Does this section help you understand what Lewis means when he argues that Virgil "must locate his action in a legendary past and yet make us feel the present, and the intervening centuries, already foreshadowed"?

- This section is another example of ekphrasis: a poetic description of a work of art. How does Virgil draw attention to the sculptural features of the shield? Could this shield actual exist as described, or is it mythical?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 66

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 65

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.266 "I, Too"

p.268 "Spring and All"

∞ Article Link: From an Atlas of the Difficult World

∞ Article Link: Caged Bird

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 3

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 66

Write your own open-form poem

→ WRITE

You get to pick the form! Write a poem about something from your books and/or life. Add a note explaining why you picked the structure/meter (or lack of it) that you did.

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33

WEEK 10 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 67

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.79-90 "There, now, I guess" - "telling those stories too."

p.116 "Will Marion Cook" - "easy and effortless."

- Why do you think Paul continued to write dialect poems? And why do they still remain important to read today, over a hundred years later?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

- COMPOSITION - Letter
Write a letter from Paul to his mother describing his time in England.

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 67

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 68

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

In Book 9, Turnus - king of the Rutulians, ally to King Latinus, and suitor of Lavinia - wages a surprise nighttime attack on the Trojans while Aeneas is away. This book describes the ensuing battle, emphasizing the courage and loyalty of the Trojans, and the human cost of war.

Today's reading picks up in the middle of a battle, and contains many vivid descriptions of violence.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 10, lines 471-774 "Suddenly Pallas runs Rhoeteus through" - "scatter all his triumph."

- Compare Pallas and Turnus: what are their similarities and differences as warriors.
- How does this passage illustrate the human cost of war? One place to look is in the epic similes.
- How are the gods involved in the outcome?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 68

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 3

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 67

Your Reference Guide

→ REVISE

Look back over the poetic architecture and environments you've studied over the year. Spend a few minutes looking over your reference book as well. Is there anything you want to add or revise?

→ READ

Reread a few of your favorite poems from over the year.

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 68

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

- Describe each poetic form in one sentence covered this year, without actually using its name. Write, record, or use voice-to-text to write your answers and edit as desired. You will refer to these in the next lesson.
- Now, describe each poetic form with one word.

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

You will need a classmate, friend, or family member to complete the assignments in the next lessons, so plan accordingly!

WEEK 10 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34

WEEK 11 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 69

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91-100 "Now, like I said" - "he'll find you right at home."

- Reflect back on what you read about Paul Laurence Dunbar this term - how would you describe his legacy?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

→ VIEW

Take a brief tour of Paul Dunbar's home in Dayton, and read about the historic site.

∞ Link: Paul Dunbar House Historic Site

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 69

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 70

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

In Book 11 and the beginning of Book 12, the two armies pause to bury their dead before the fighting continues. Our final reading from The



Term 3

Aeneid picks up at the final duel between Aeneas and Turnus.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 12, lines 916-1113 "Now at the same moment" - "down to the shades below."

- What role do the gods play in this final confrontation?
- Why does Aeneas hesitate? What makes him change his mind?
- What do you think of how the epic ends? Why do you think Virgil decided to end the story with the moment of Turnus's death, rather than with peace and the establishment of Rome?

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 70

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 69

Materials: Activity from Lesson 68

→ PREP

Make sure you have your list of words and list of sentences on hand!

→ SHARE

Give a friend, classmate, family member, or teacher the list of forms you have studied over the year (skip this step if you want to make this activity harder!). Then give them your list of words from the last lesson and see if they can guess which words describe which forms. If they struggle, share your one-sentence description of each of the forms and see how they do. Then explain why you chose the words and descriptions you did.

★ CLASSROOM TIP

If using these lessons in a classroom setting, students could complete the assignment with each other or as homework with a parent. Regardless, be sure to leave room for students to share and discuss their descriptions and words with each other as students will likely have different ways of describing the various poetic forms, even though themes and some similarities should also emerge.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 70

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ REVISE

Look back over the poems you wrote this year. Pick one and revise it. Now that you have had some time to read other things and let your poem rest, you may find you'd like to change words, fix the meter, etc.

→ SHARE

Of the poems you have read this year, read your favorite ones to a friend or family member. Tell why it is a favorite. As a bonus, read one of the poems YOU wrote this year!

WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

WEEK 12 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
The Aeneid

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 71

Literature: Grade 9

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Term 3	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 72 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Jump Back, Paul	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 72	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 71 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The Making of a Poem	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 72 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The Making of a Poem	
WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36	

Literature: Grade 9

Examination

Term 1

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

- Discuss some of the defining authors and characteristics of the literature written in the first half of the 1800s that we've studied so far. Organize your thoughts into at least two paragraphs.

Poetry Study: Grade 9

- Scan or turn in one of your "at-a-glance" pages in your reference guide.
- The Making of a Poem: Write a few lines about a poem you read this term. Include the name and form of the poem in your description.

Term 2

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

- Describe some of the genres you've studied this term and tell about one particular piece or author you read about with more detail.

Poetry Study: Grade 9

- Scan or turn in one of your "at-a-glance" pages in your reference guide.
- The Making of a Poem: Briefly explain the history of one of the poetic forms you studied this term (Sonnet, Ballad, etc.)

Term 3

Poetry Study: Grade 9

- The Making of a Poem: Scan or turn in your list of descriptions and words from lesson 68.
- The Making of a Poem: Write a few lines about a poem you read this term. Include the name and form of the poem in your description.